DAYONE VENTURES

Who we are for, and where.

Sponsors and management teams of lower-middle-market software companies ($5M–$40M ARR) who need the operating work done, not advised, in any market except India and Nigeria.

01

Sponsors

PE firms, independent sponsors, search funds, family offices and holdcos with lower-middle-market software.

Titles — Partner, Principal, Operating Partner, VP Portfolio Operations

Trigger — New acquisition and a hundred-day plan that needs owners; a portfolio company stuck flat.

02

Portfolio management teams

CEO and CFO of a sponsor-backed software company with $5M–$40M ARR.

Titles — CEO, CFO, COO, Chief Product Officer

Trigger — Net revenue retention below target, margin pressure, a board asking for a bigger number.

03

Founders and owners

Owners of software or tech-enabled businesses weighing a control or structured partner.

Titles — Founder, CEO, Chair

Trigger — Pre-exit in 12–24 months; growth has plateaued; wants a higher multiple, not just a buyer.

FIRMOGRAPHIC FIT

- $5M–$40M ARR software or tech-enabled services
- Earnings flat or under-managed; two or more operating levers to pull (revenue, margin, product)
- Holding period still ahead, or exit readiness needed within 24 months
- Decision maker reachable: sponsor partner or CEO

QUALIFY IN THE FIRST CALL

- Which sponsor or owner, and what is the ARR?
- Which of the six value dimensions hurts most: GTM, margin, NRR, pricing, defensibility, cost?
- Who owns the number after we leave the room?
- What is the exit or hold horizon?

NOT OUR ICP

- Pre-revenue, consumer hardware or non-software businesses
- Requests for advice or slide work only, with no appetite for operating accountability
- Vendors, list sellers, agencies and service resellers
- Buyer or company headquartered in India or Nigeria

GEOGRAPHY: ANYWHERE EXCEPT INDIA AND NIGERIA

Core · United States | United Kingdom & Ireland | Canada | EU & Nordics | Australia & New Zealand | UAE, Saudi Arabia & Qatar | Singapore | Israel | Brazil & Mexico | Everywhere else | ✕ India | ✕ Nigeria

How it is enforced. Leads from India or Nigeria (detected from the phone code, email domain or stated location) are flagged “Outside ICP region” and left out of every KPI and the funnel counts. Turn on “Show test & spam” on the Leads page to review them. Outbound lists exclude accounts headquartered there. **Right now:** 0 of 17 Dayone Ventures submissions are outside the region.

DAYONE VENTURES

Sponsors do not read brochures, so a Value Map. Reach, capture, convert.

A sponsor or software CEO does not want a pitch. They want to know where value is leaking in a company and what it is worth fixing. So the content that fills each stage is diagnostic proof: a benchmark, a scorecard and a scoped diagnostic, built as a small set of repeatable assets that share one voice and one next step.

TOFU · REACH

Where is the value leaking?

Goal: Put the right sponsors and CEOs in front of a specific, quotable diagnosis, so the first thing they learn about Dayone is a useful answer.

ASSETS

- **Value Leak benchmark posts.** One post per diagnostic dimension: go-to-market efficiency, gross margin, retention, pricing, defensibility, cost. Open with the question a sponsor asks, then answer it.
- **Operator, not advisor.** Why the holding period is the product, and how an operating partner differs from a consultant. Written so AI assistants can quote it.
- **Day-One 100-day plan.** The first hundred days after close, mapped to Diagnose and Operate, as a one-page template.
- **Named outbound list.** Twenty hand-picked lower-middle-market software companies and their sponsors per week, each with one specific observation. India and Nigeria headquartered accounts are excluded.

CHANNELS

LinkedIn led by the partners, sponsor and operating-partner newsletters, search and answer engines, introductions from portfolio executives and the Dayone technology group, sponsor conferences in core markets.

MEASURE

ICP accounts reached per week, outbound reply rate, non-brand search impressions, and how often AI assistants name Dayone in a weekly ten-prompt check. One metric to beat: ICP replies per week.

LIVE NOW Traffic is not connected yet (needs GA4 and Search Console). Audit: 10/10 AI crawlers allowed, 0 sitemap URLs, 1526 words visible to crawlers.

MOFU · CAPTURE

The Value Map sample

Goal: Turn a reader into a named contact inside the ICP who has raised their hand. Today the only exit is a contact form.

ASSETS

- **Value Map sample.** A redacted one-page diagnostic: six dimensions, a ranked list of interventions, and what each is worth. Organisation and role required to download.
- **Portfolio scorecard.** Ten questions a sponsor answers about one company. Returns a leak score and the two dimensions to look at first.
- **Operating library notes.** One lesson a month from the proprietary operating library, sent to captured contacts.
- **Sponsor briefing.** Thirty minutes, under NDA, walking one live company through the four-phase framework.

CHANNELS

One landing page with three choices: get the sample, score a company, book a briefing. Comment keyword ("MAP") on LinkedIn posts. Capture organisation, role and country on every form.

MEASURE

Captures per 100 visits, ICP-qualified share of captures, scorecard completions, briefings booked. Baseline in week 4 before setting targets.

LIVE NOW 17 submissions to date, 2 qualified and in region. Capture rate per visit needs traffic data.

BOFU · CONVERT

Diagnostic before capital

Goal: A first scoped diagnostic inside the quarter, and a mandate that runs across the holding period.

ASSETS

- **Scoped diagnostic.** One company, six dimensions, a Value Map in a fixed window. "No capital moves ahead of the diagnosis."
- **Proof stack.** The four-phase framework, the captive technology group, and the 100+ production platforms it has delivered, each linked to its source page.
- **Sponsor references.** With consent, a named reference or a dated before and after. No invented testimonials.
- **Mandate proposal.** Diagnose, Operate, Compound, Realize, with scope, fees and the numbers Dayone is accountable for.

EXPANSION LOOP

After a diagnostic, propose a second company in the same portfolio and ask for two introductions.

MEASURE

Capture to briefing, briefing to diagnostic, diagnostic to mandate, cycle length in days, and declared pipeline. Baseline these in week 4 before setting targets.

LIVE NOW 0 hot, 0 warm, no declared pipeline yet.

FIX BEFORE ANY OF IT

- Publish llms.txt: a curated map of the pages above for AI assistants.
- Add robots.txt and sitemap.xml (both return 404 today) so search and AI crawlers can discover every asset.
- Add FAQ structured data to the answer pages so assistants can lift direct answers.
- 88% of form submissions are tests, cold pitches or out-of-region. Add a honeypot or Turnstile and a Country field to the form before driving traffic to it.
- Align the declared service area with the ICP: the site schema says areaServed United States only, while the ICP is every market except India and Nigeria.

MON	WED	THU	FRI	SUN
Value Leak benchmark post	Scorecard share with comment keyword	Twenty outbound messages, one specific observation each	Operating library note to captured list	Review ICP fit of the week's leads, pick next week's list